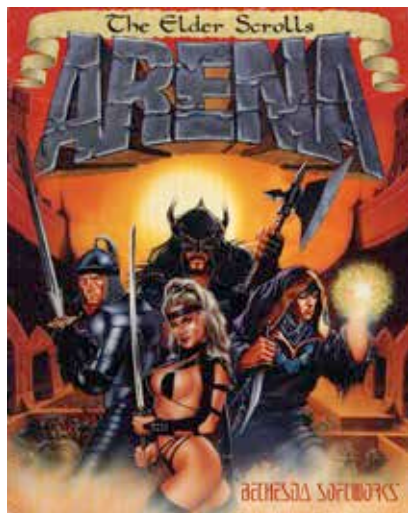


RPG genre in general and we've come to expect them in every Elder Scrolls game since. The elements we're talking about here are of course the total freedom given to the player, which was evident right from the start of the game with the character customization. Then there's the open world, oh gawd the open world! Go where you please, do as you please, so many things to do. The possibilities were limitless! It comes as no surprise that critics praised The Elder Scrolls for managing to pull this off so successfully, no TES game goes by without receiving praise from critics for the freedom the game gives to its players.

So let's not waste any more time and get right into this Legendary Saga of games that is The Elder Scrolls!

The Elder Scrolls **ARENA**

The Elder Scrolls: Arena released waaay back in 1994, which makes it even older than some of our readers! What was originally meant to be just a gladiator type tournament fighting game with side quests evolved to become a full-scale RPG with a cult-following. How did this happen you ask? Well you could say that the team working on Arena got side-tracked by the side quests, like almost all of us do with Elder Scrolls games, and they ended up having more meat to them than the actual fighting. So much so that they actually ended up adding dungeons and cities; at this point you couldn't really call it a tournament



fighting game anymore, so they decided it would be a first person RPG instead.

Now, not everything Bethesda touches turns into gold. The Elder Scrolls: Arena did not do too well, it actually got pretty negative reviews and didn't too well in the sales department either. Our guess is this was probably due to the title, which was pretty misleading. The Elder Scrolls: Arena doesn't really seem like the title you'd give to an RPG not focused on combat. Oh well, mistakes were made but the game had still developed a cult like following.

Now here's an interesting tidbit for you guys, Arena is the only Elder Scroll game – well other than Elder Scrolls: Online which we aren't counting – where you could travel the entirety of Tamriel. Yes, the WHOLE continent. If you were intimidated by the scale of the games now, think about back then.

In Arena you start by escaping from a prison, which you were locked in by an evil wizard who's also gone and banished the Emperor into another dimension. You had to collect magical artifacts in order to defeat him. Yea, it's a pretty bare-bones story.

The Elder Scrolls II **DAGGERFALL**

Daggerfall was released two years later, on the 31st of August in 1996. The work on Arena's sequel had begun almost immediately after Arena was released. While the game was initially going to be set in Morrowind, the location was later changed to include Hammerfell and High Rock instead. That's the Redguard and Breton provinces, respectively, if you're wondering. Daggerfall came with quite a few big changes to the system. The first big change was the ability to create your own class, rather than picking one of the predetermined ones from the roster. They also got rid of experience points, opting instead for a system

which revolved around skills. You should be beginning to see the similarities now.

Now if you thought Arena was huge, well you're right it was, but Daggerfall was massive, even though it only featured two of the provinces instead of the whole continent, it's still arguably one of the largest game worlds ever. Period.

The map was so full of towns, dungeons and cities they were each represented by a single pixel on the world map. And there were MANY pixels on this map; 15,000 for that matter. If you had to make a comparison, Morrowind – the sequel – is only 0.01% the size of Daggerfall! Bethesda themselves say the map is the size of Great Britain.

However, Daggerfall's release was plagued with bugs, something Bethesda has kind of become infamous for, and a habit they still haven't quite curbed yet, but we still love them. If you think you've got what it takes to tackle this massive world, Daggerfall was made legally free to download as of July 2009, so give it a go if you can stomach the graphics of the 90s. :)

Creating your own custom class, and the new skill system wherein you chose your primary skills to level up were all seen for the first time in Daggerfall,

